Yifan Zhu

AI Product Designer · From user research to live products

Glasgow, UK · Open to relocation
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Portfolio: yifan-zhu-portfolio-2026.netlify.app

Product designer focused on AI products. I research with the people involved, design the interaction, then build working products with AI-assisted development and put them in front of real users. Shipped an **AI assistant used by 100+ people**, a **live booking system for a Glasgow salon** and **LOOK, with portfolios for 40+ local creators**. MDes Design Innovation and Transformation, The Glasgow School of Art; BA Environmental Design.

SELECTED PRODUCTS

Screen Context Assistant — Independent multimodal AI product · Product guide / source

- Designed the end-to-end interaction for a Windows AI tool that extracts, translates, explains and summarises anything on screen: task selection, region capture, input preview, waiting and error states, floating results, copying and isolated temporary sessions.
- Built it with AI-assisted implementation and **released it to 100+ users** under the MIT licence; fixed high-DPI capture offsets and ran **13 offline regression checks** on coordinates, image input, session isolation and errors.

Glasgow Salon Booking & Scheduling — Live UK product · Live booking · Case study

- **Live since 21 October 2026** for a salon averaging **90–120 appointments and 70–80 visits a week** over six trading days. Led requirements, service blueprints, booking rules and the English/Chinese customer experience; collaborated on the owner interface.
- Designed a **3-step booking flow and 4 admin entry points**, turning service duration, availability, bookings and closures into slot and status rules; validated **17 business scenarios**, including rescheduling, cancellation and closures.

LOOK — UK local styling platform · two-sided marketplace · Case study / prototype

- Designed a **work sample → creator → service** journey to close the gap between a reference image and finding the right practitioner; delivered product scope, information architecture and a runnable customer/creator prototype for comparison, quotes and booking requests.
- Gathered needs from Glasgow hair and beauty practitioners in person and over WhatsApp; built **portfolios for 40+ creators across 10+ local shops**, demonstrated it to **100+ local people** and completed 55 targeted regression checks.

Cyber Projection Toolkit — Released commercial Blender add-on · Case study / demo

- Owned requirements, parameter design, AI-assisted implementation, testing and release; turned complex node set-ups into adjustable effects and presets, with demos, tutorials and documentation, iterating from support feedback.
- Part of my digital-resource catalogue, which reaches **600+ users and 2,000+ downloads/claims** across platforms (catalogue-wide figures, not this tool alone).

EXPERIENCE

Creative Planning & Content Design Intern · Institution Under Construction — Italy, remote · Aug 2026 – present

English-language collaboration · Official project · Film course / guests

- Planned and produced course promotions featuring **50 international faculty members** for Course for Non-Curators, published on the institution website, with contributors including Hou Hanru, Charles Esche and Mieke Bal; turned 8 course groups into visual themes and landscape/portrait videos.
- Planned promotion for a film course with **13 international guests across 12 themes**, including Paolo Bertolin and Davide Ferrario; delivered scene scripts, 17 pages of English references and 30 indexed images.
- Evaluated AI and design tools against audience, goals and delivery needs, and built a research → theme → script/storyboard → visual production → review workflow.

SKILLS

Design	User research, interaction design, AI and multimodal interaction states, information architecture, service blueprints, business rules, prototyping, validation and iteration
Build with AI	AI-assisted development with Codex and Claude Code, ChatGPT, Git/GitHub, Python project practice, developer collaboration
Visual & AIGC	Figma, Blender, ComfyUI, Higgsfield
Languages	Chinese (native), English (professional working proficiency)

EDUCATION & AWARDS

The Glasgow School of Art · MDes Design Innovation and Transformation — Sep 2025 – Sep 2026

Course completed; degree expected November 2026. Focus: service design, user research and systems thinking.

Hunan City University · BA Environmental Design (Landscape Design) — Sep 2021 – Jun 2025

International Frontier Innovation Design Competition, Gold (2024); 10th Zhongzhuang Cup, National Second Prize (2024); Hunan Public Service Advertising Competition, First Prize (2022). 3 international, 2 national and 10+ provincial awards. Led planning, research and presentation for an arts-led rural development project, selected as a Future Designer outstanding case and published (NCDAAL1240056).